PADHAKU
Kaveri · Class 9 English

CHAPTER 4

Vitamin-M

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Reflect and Respond

I **Complete the graphic organiser 'Caring for the Elderly':**

- **What are the problems faced by the elderly?**
- **What could be the possible reasons for the problems faced?**
- **Why should we care for the elderly?**
- **How can we take care of the elderly?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Problems: weak eyesight and hearing, poor memory, joint pain, loneliness, falling ill often.

Reasons: old age weakens the body; children live far away or are busy; no one to talk to.

Why care: they looked after us; they give us love, stories and wise advice; they deserve respect.

How: give medicines on time, take them for check-ups, spend time talking and playing with them, help with daily work, listen to them patiently.

II **Fill in the table (tick how well you know the word and write its meaning):**

1. frail 2. shuddered 3. poky 4. forbid 5. pottering 6. winced

✔ ANSWER

1. **frail** – weak and thin (because of old age)
2. **shuddered** – shook suddenly from fear or an unpleasant memory
3. **poky** – (of a room or flat) small and cramped

4. **forbid** – to order someone not to do something

5. **pottering** – doing small, light jobs in a relaxed way

6. **winced** – showed an expression of pain or embarrassment

III **Think of a tradition, story, or recipe passed down by grandparents or an elderly relative. What does it mean to you? How does it connect you to your growing-up years?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

My grandmother taught me to make besan laddoos for Diwali. Every year we make them together.

For me it means love and togetherness. The smell of roasting besan reminds me of my childhood and of her stories while we cooked.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Check Your Understanding (Part I)

I **Why did Grandpa dislike living in the city with his daughter?**

✔ ANSWER

He hated the noise and bustle of the crowded city and called the flat 'poky'. He missed his quiet brick house with the mango tree. He also felt he was being treated like a baby and was not allowed to go out alone.

II **Why did Vidya not want her father to go out alone?**

✔ ANSWER

Grandpa had become forgetful. He once took a double dose of medicine, once got lost on a walk and forgot the way home, and once fell in his garden and lay outside all night. So she felt it was too dangerous.

III **Was Ravi in favour of his mother treating Grandpa like a child? How can you say so?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Ravi **winced** at the over-loud tone his mother used with Grandpa, as though she were speaking to a child who couldn't hear or understand.

IV **Would Ravi be able to keep up his promise to his mother?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

No, not fully. Grandpa went out on his own, and Ravi could not stop him without hurting his feelings. Ravi could only follow him secretly to keep him safe.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Check Your Understanding (Part II)

I **Complete the flow chart of Grandpa's day out:**

Grandpa goes out to get Tamil newspaper → Ravi follows Grandpa → Grandpa first stops at 1. ___ →

buys 2. ___ and watches ___ → Ravi hides behind a bush → Grandpa next goes to 3. ___ → Ravi hides behind a banyan tree → Ravi gets scolded by 4. ___ and ___ → Grandpa drinks 5. ___ and eats ___ → crosses the road and enters a 6. ___ → walks quickly to a 7. ___ and ___ → Ravi enters the bus only to discover he had been fooled.

✔ ANSWER

1. the children's park
2. a paper-cone of peanuts; the children play
3. the tea stall
4. the lady selling plastic combs and the vendor selling ribbons and clips (the vendors)
5. a sugary cup of tea; two bananas (and an ice cream)
6. barber shop
7. bus stop; boards the first bus

II Was Grandpa lost as feared by Ravi's mother?

✔ ANSWER

No. Grandpa was not lost. He reached home safely on his own and was sleeping in his bedroom when Ravi came back.

III How would Ravi feel after seeing Grandpa?

✔ ANSWER

He would feel great delight and relief, and a rush of love for Grandpa. He might also feel foolish for being tricked.

IV **Do you think Ravi's mother will get to know about what had happened?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Partly. Grandpa himself told her that Ravi 'just disappeared' instead of staying at home. But she may never know that Grandpa went out alone and Ravi was following him.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Check Your Understanding (Part III)

I **Describe how Ravi's emotional reaction upon finding Grandpa safe at home reveals his feelings towards his grandfather.**

✔ ANSWER

Ravi felt great delight and relief. He knelt by the bed, put his cheek against Grandpa's face and hugged him, overcome with affection. This shows he loves Grandpa deeply and was truly worried for him.

II **What might be the significance of Grandpa's habit of giving gifts to everyone on his birthday rather than receiving them?**

✔ ANSWER

It shows he is generous and loving. He finds joy in giving, not receiving. He still thinks of his family as his 'babies' and wants to care for them.

III **Why do you think Grandpa gave Ravi a detective story book as a gift? What might this suggest about Grandpa's awareness of Ravi's actions earlier in the day?**

✔ ANSWER

Grandpa knew Ravi had been following him. He joked that the book would teach Ravi 'how to avoid getting fooled when one is trailing a suspect'. It suggests he noticed Ravi and even fooled him on purpose by giving his cap away.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **Extract: 'Grandpa hated the noise and bustle of city life ... no one at home to help him up.' Choose the emotion displayed by the Grandfather: A. regretful B. apologetic C. nostalgic D. wistful**

✔ ANSWER

C. nostalgic – he speaks longingly of his old brick house and its peace.

I 1 (ii) **Complete: Grandpa hated the busy and noisy city life because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

he loved the peace and quiet of his small brick house in town, where 'you can even hear a leaf fall'.

I 1 (iii) **Why did Grandpa come to the city despite his dislike for city life?**

✔ ANSWER

He had slipped and fallen in his garden and lain outside all night with no one to help. So his daughter locked up his house and brought him to live with her.

I 1 (iv) **Choose an expression similar in meaning to 'you can even hear a leaf fall': A. end of one's life B. arrival of autumn C. sign of good luck D. pin drop silence**

✔ ANSWER

D. pin drop silence – both mean it is extremely quiet.

I 1 (v) **State one advantage and one disadvantage of the Grandfather living in the house in town.**

✔ ANSWER

Advantage: peace, quiet and freedom in his own home with a garden.

Disadvantage: he lived alone, so no one was there to help him when he fell.

I 2 (i) **Extract: '"I had a quiet morning, but I don't know about Ravi ..." ... "Have you forgotten?" exclaimed Ravi's mother, impatiently.' Choose the tone of the Grandfather's response: A. apologetic B. hurtful C. calm D.**

puzzled

✔ ANSWER

C. calm – he answered 'coolly'.

I 2 (ii) **Why was Ravi confused and embarrassed?**

✔ ANSWER

Grandpa told his mother that Ravi had disappeared. Ravi could not explain without revealing he had followed Grandpa, and he wondered how Grandpa knew.

I 2 (iii) **Complete: Ravi's mother was impatient because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

she thought Grandpa had forgotten that Ravi's birthday was three months ago.

I 2 (iv) **True or false: Grandfather forgot that Ravi's birthday was three months ago.**

✔ ANSWER

False. He remembered; he gives gifts to every child in the house on his own birthday.

I 2 (v) **Why did Grandpa say he didn't know what kind of morning Ravi might have had?**

✔ ANSWER

Because Ravi had left the house to follow him secretly. Grandpa knew this and was teasing Ravi, pretending Ravi had not stayed home to look after him.

II 1 **Grandpa is portrayed as a person with failing memory. Give two evidences to disprove the statement.**

✔ ANSWER

- He remembered thousands of chess games, e.g. Karpov's opening move and Bobby Fischer's mistake against Spassky.
- He remembered his own birthday and his gift-giving custom, which his daughter had forgotten. (He also found his way home alone.)

II 2 **Give two characteristic traits of: (i) Grandfather (ii) Ravi (iii) Ravi's mother**

✔ ANSWER

(i) **Grandfather:** independent and self-respecting; witty and clever (also generous).

(ii) **Ravi:** caring and responsible; loyal and determined.

(iii) **Ravi's mother:** caring and anxious; busy and over-protective (she forgets her father's birthday).

II 3 **Why was Ravi worried about what Grandfather had at the tea stall?**

✔ ANSWER

Grandpa had a sugary cup of tea, two bananas and an ice cream. Sugar and bananas were forbidden for him at home, so they could harm his health. Ravi knew his mother 'would faint' if she saw it.

Q 4 **Do you think it was easy for Ravi to follow his Grandfather? If yes, why? If no, why not?**

✔ ANSWER

No. A child's mother scolded him in the park and he had to crawl out; the vendors surrounded him; he was thrown out of a ladies' salon; he had to sprint to jump on a bus; and in the end he followed the wrong yellow cap.

Q 5 **'Ravi is a good detective'. Give one argument in favour of and against the statement.**

✔ ANSWER

For: he was determined – he followed Grandpa everywhere and even jumped on a moving bus.

Against: he was noticed by many people and was easily fooled by the yellow cap, so he lost Grandpa.

Q 6 **Was Grandfather aware that Ravi was following him? How do you know?**

✔ ANSWER

Yes. He told Ravi's mother that Ravi 'just disappeared', gave Ravi a detective book with tips on 'how to avoid getting fooled when ... trailing a suspect', and had a twinkle in his eye. He probably gave away his cap on purpose.

II 7 **In your opinion, who needs Vitamin-M? And why?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Ravi's mother needs Vitamin-M. She thought Grandpa's memory was weak, but she herself forgot her father's birthday even though she had circled it on the calendar.

II 8 **Give an example where you experienced or observed discrimination based on age, when opinions were disregarded because of age.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

At a family meeting about buying a new phone, my suggestion was ignored because I was 'too young', though I knew the features best. Similarly, my grandmother's advice is sometimes brushed aside as 'old-fashioned'. Every person's opinion should be heard, whatever their age.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Vocabulary and Structures in Context

I (a) **Classify into movement words (Column 1) and sound words (Column 2):**

pottering, boomed, twirling, crouch, bustle, crawl, creeping, thudded, ducked, shrieks, zigzagging, whirr, evicted, briskly, sprinting, grunted, jumping, darted, trailing, snoring

✔ ANSWER

Column 1 (movement): pottering, twirling, crouch, crawl, creeping, ducked, zigzagging, evicted, briskly, sprinting, jumping, darted, trailing

Column 2 (sound): boomed, bustle, thudded, shrieks, whirr, grunted, snoring

I (b) **Fill in the blanks in the passage about Detective Shankar with words from Column 1 or 2.**

✔ ANSWER

Detective Shankar, 1. **trailing** the mysterious suspect through the dimly lit side lanes, away from the 2. **bustle** of the city, quickened his pace 3. **briskly**. The suspect's heavy footsteps 4. **thudded** across the street, unaware of the pursuit. Shankar 5. **twirling** his magnifying glass had to 6. **crouch** behind the market stalls, 7. **creeping** through the lanes to avoid being seen. Shankar 8. **grunted** when he hit himself against a pole. This alarmed the suspect and he 9. **darted** into the night leaving only the distant 10. **snoring** of the sleeping city behind.

(Other fitting words are also acceptable, e.g. 7. zigzagging, 10. whirr.)

II **Fill in synonyms of 'dilemma': 1. QU_ND_ _Y 2. PR_D_C_M_NT**

✔ ANSWER

1. **QUANDARY**
2. **PREDICAMENT**

III **Give part of speech, meaning, synonym and antonym: 1. craftily 2. dilemma 3. furious 4. boomed 5. humiliation 6. attire**

✔ ANSWER

Word	Part of speech	Meaning	Synonym	Antonym
craftily	adverb	in a clever, tricky way	cunningly, slyly	openly, honestly
dilemma	noun	a situation where one must make a difficult choice	predicament	certainty
furious	adjective	extremely angry	enraged	calm
boomed	verb	made a loud, deep sound	thundered	whispered

humiliation	noun	a feeling of shame and loss of self-respect	disgrace	pride, honour
attire	noun	clothes, dress	clothing, outfit	nakedness

IV **Match Column 1 with Column 2 (one meaning is extra):**

1. embarrassed 2. countered 3. flushed 4. stricken 5. gleam

(i) affected severely by an unpleasant feeling (ii) to be confused (iii) expression of emotion (iv) reply to an argument (v) felt uncomfortable (vi) became red in the face

✔ ANSWER

1 – (v) felt uncomfortable

2 – (iv) reply to an argument

3 – (vi) became red in the face

4 – (i) affected severely by an unpleasant feeling

5 – (iii) expression of emotion

Extra: (ii) to be confused

V (a) **Underline the prepositions:**

1. I'll just walk across to the corner shop... 2. ... he felt a shadow fall over him... 3. ...the vendors sitting under the tree... 4. Ravi took position behind a big banyan...

✔ ANSWER

1. **across** (also 'to')

2. **over**
3. **under**
4. **behind**

V (b) **Fill in the blanks with appropriate prepositions: I walked (i) ___ (through, between, against) the village, crossed a bridge (ii) ___ (over, under, beside) a brook, and found a quiet garden (iii) ___ (among, near, across) a cottage. Sitting on a bench (iv) ___ (on, at, in) the garden, I enjoyed the peaceful surroundings. Later, I strolled (v) ___ (beside, through, along) a riverbank ... heading (vi) ___ (into, towards, beyond) the unknown.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) **through** (ii) **over** (iii) **near** (iv) **in** (v) **along** (vi) **towards**

VI Dialogues: 1. “Shall we play chess or watch the cricket match on TV, Grandpa?” 2. “Who are you?” 3. “What did you both do today?” 4. “Have you forgotten?” 5. “Are you playing hide and seek?”

A. The words in the quotes are (i) ___ (exclamatory/interrogative) sentences.

B. Sentences 1, 4 and 5 are (ii) ___ (Wh-/Yes, No type) interrogative sentences.

C. Sentences 2 and 3 are (iii) ___ (Wh-/Yes, No type).

So, there are (iv) ___ (two/three) types of interrogative sentences.

✔ ANSWER

(i) **interrogative**

(ii) **Yes/No type**

(iii) **Wh- type**

(iv) **two**

VII **Arvind: Do you help in taking care of your grandparents at home?**

Priya: Yes, I do. We take turns making sure they're alright. Do you have grandparents living with you?

Arvind: No. My parents and I visit my grandpa every weekend. How do you manage your grandparents' medical needs?

Priya: We have a schedule for giving medications and visits to the doctor.

Complete in reported speech (blanks 1–6).

✔ ANSWER

Arvind asked Priya if she 1. **helped in taking care of her grandparents at home** for which Priya replied in the affirmative and said that they 2. **took turns making sure they were alright**. Priya further asked Arvind 3. **if he had grandparents living with him**. Arvind replied in the negative and said that 4. **his parents and he visited his grandpa** every weekend. He further enquired 5. **how she managed her grandparents' medical needs**. Priya responded by saying that they 6. **had a schedule for giving medications and visits to the doctor**.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Listen and Respond

1 **Meditation is a form of yoga that usually refreshes the mind and helps with ___.**

✔ ANSWER

stress management

2 Meditation leads to a better health condition both ___.

✔ ANSWER

physically and emotionally

3 Meditation also aids in lessening undesirable feelings and improving ___.

✔ ANSWER

self-awareness

4 It is advised that we meditate every day so that it becomes a ___.

✔ ANSWER

routine

5 Meditating on a daily basis is beneficial in comfortably tackling ___.

✔ ANSWER

exam-related pressure

🧪 Vitamin-M · Speaking Activity

I Revisit the story and select different questions. Work in pairs and practise speaking them aloud with correct intonation.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Wh-/How (falling ↘): “Who are you?” “What did you both do today?” “Who are you hiding from?”
- Yes/No (rising ↗): “Have you forgotten?” “Are you playing hide and seek?” “Has she told you not to let me go out on my own?”
- Choice (rise-fall ↗↘): “Shall we play chess or watch the cricket match on TV, Grandpa?”
- Question tag: e.g. “You followed me today, didn't you?” (rising – fairly sure).

II **Make a presentation about a brief personal experience of taking care of an older person (background, what you learned about yourself, what you learned about the older person).**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

The person I had the privilege of taking care of was my grandfather, when he broke his leg last winter. I gave him his medicines on time, brought his meals and read the newspaper to him.

Caring for him taught me valuable lessons about myself, including patience. I learned that I possess the ability to stay calm and responsible.

Understanding his needs, I learned that older people want company and respect more than anything. His challenges offered insights into the difficulties of ageing, such as weak eyesight and loneliness. Caring for him deepened my understanding of the ageing process and made me more kind.

⭐ Vitamin-M · Writing Task

I **Write an article for your school magazine on 'Our Inspiring Elderly' (title, name and grade; four paragraphs: introduction, how the elderly inspire, how they overcame challenges and their impact on you, conclusion).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Our Inspiring Elderly

by Asha Kumari, Class 9

The elderly are the roots of every family. They carry years of experience, wisdom and love. We have a lot to learn from them, if only we stop and listen.

Our grandparents inspire us in many ways. My grandfather still walks five kilometres every morning at 72. My grandmother remembers every festival recipe and tells stories that teach honesty and courage. As the saying goes, 'An old man's word is a treasure.' Many elders also learn new things, like using mobile phones, to stay in touch with us.

Most of them have faced hard times – poverty, illness and loss – yet they never gave up. My grandfather studied under a street lamp and became a teacher. His patience and hard work inspire me to keep going when my studies feel difficult.

Let us respect our elders, spend time with them and value their advice. Their experience is a guide that no book can replace. When we care for them today, we learn how to live well tomorrow.

📘 Vitamin-M · Learning Beyond the Text

I **Revisit the story and choose the image that correctly displays Grandpa's walking stick.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The **second** stick – the one with a brass handle carved in the shape of an **eagle's head**. The story describes a 'shiny-black mahogany walking stick with a brass handle carved in the shape of an eagle's head'. (check the picture in your book)

II **Collect memorable photographs of yourself and your family and make a slide show: when and where it was clicked, who is in it, why it is memorable.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Slide 1: 'Our trip to Shimla, May 2023' – me, my parents and my sister on the Mall Road. Memorable because it was our first family holiday and my first sight of snow-covered mountains.

Slide 2: 'Dadi's 75th birthday, at home, Jan 2024' – the whole family around the cake. Memorable because all our relatives came together after many years.

III **Read the story 'The Lost Child' (Mulk Raj Anand) and discuss it with your classmates and teacher.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- At the fair the child wants a toy, burfi, a garland, balloons and a ride, but walks on knowing his parents would refuse.
- When he loses his parents, nothing attracts him any more; he only cries, 'I want my mother, I want my father!'
- Message: love and the safety of family matter far more than any material thing. Just as Ravi looked after Grandpa, families must take care of members of every age.

I Cannot Remember My Mother · Reflect and Respond

I **Work in pairs. Discuss the memories from your childhood that you remember. List them and share.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- My mother singing a lullaby at night.
- Learning to ride a bicycle with my father holding the seat.
- Making paper boats in the rain.
- My first day at school and my new water bottle.

II **Discuss how children's relationship with their mother can influence their emotions and memories.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

A mother is usually a child's first teacher and source of comfort. Her love makes a child feel safe and confident. Songs, smells and words linked with her stay in our memory for life, and they comfort us even when she is not near.

III **Match Column 1 with Column 2:**

1. hover 2. hum 3. cradle 4. shiuli 5. morning service 6. gaze

(i) sing a tune with your lips closed (ii) a type of flower (coral jasmine) (iii) look steadily for a long time (iv) rituals conducted in a temple (v) linger or remain near a place (vi) a small bed for a baby

✔ ANSWER

1 – (v)

2 – (i)

3 – (vi)

4 – (ii)

5 – (iv)

6 – (iii)

⭐ I Cannot Remember My Mother · Check Your Understanding

I Stanza 1 **1. The poet remembers his mother while he ___.**

2. The poet remembers the ___ but not the ___.

Setting: ___ (outdoor/indoor)

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. **plays** (in the midst of his play)

2. **tune** (of a song); **song** (he cannot recall the song itself or his mother)

Setting: **indoor**

I Stanza 2 **1. The poet remembers his mother in the ___ season.**

2. The poet remembers his mother by the smell of ___.

Setting: ___

✔ ANSWER

1. **autumn** (early autumn morning)

2. **shiuli flowers** (and the scent of the morning service in the temple)

Setting: **outdoor**

I Stanza 3 **1. The poet feels that his mother ___ at him from the ___.**

Setting: ___

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. **gazes** (looks); **sky**

Setting: **indoor** (he looks out from his bedroom window)

II **Give examples of references to senses (olfactory, auditory, visual) from the poem and complete the table.**

✔ ANSWER

Stanza	Lines from the poem	Sense

1	...the tune of some song that she used to hum while rocking my cradle	auditory
2	...the smell of the shiuli flowers floats in the air / the scent of the morning service in the temple	olfactory
3	...I send my eyes into the blue of the distant sky ... my mother's gaze on my face has spread all over the sky	visual

III 1 **Two examples of alliteration from the poem are (i) ___ and (ii) ___.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) **'some song'** (ii) **'my mother'** (also 'smell of the shiuli', 'stillness ... spread ... sky')

III 2 **An example of onomatopoeia is ___.**

✔ ANSWER

hum

III 3 **The poem uses imagery extensively. Explain.**

✔ ANSWER

The poet uses images of all senses: sound (a tune hovering over playthings, humming while rocking the cradle), smell (shiuli flowers, the scent of the morning temple service) and sight (the blue of the distant sky, the mother's still gaze spread over it). These images help us feel his faint memories of his mother.

III 4 **Although the poem does not have a rhyme scheme, it is enjoyable because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

it has a gentle, musical flow, a repeated refrain, beautiful sensory images and deep, tender emotion.

III 5 **What is the tone of the poet? Why do you say so?**

✔ ANSWER

The tone is **nostalgic and tender (wistful)**. He longs for the mother he cannot remember, yet feels her loving presence in a tune, a scent and the sky.

III 6 **What impact does the title of the poem have on the overall mood of the poem?**

✔ ANSWER

The title tells us at once about the poet's loss. It creates a sad, longing mood, which turns gentle and comforting as he finds his mother in small sensory memories.

III 7 **The poet uses 'I cannot remember my mother' as a refrain because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

it stresses his deep sense of loss and links the three stanzas; each time it is followed by a 'but/only' memory showing that he still feels her presence.

III 8 **Identify the symbols used in the poem to indicate the memory of his mother's presence.**

✔ ANSWER

- **The tune/song** – her love and the lullaby she sang.
- **Shiuli flowers and the scent of the temple service** – her purity, gentleness and devotion.
- **The sky** – her calm, endless, protecting love (her gaze spread all over the sky).

I Cannot Remember My Mother · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **Extract: 'I cannot remember my mother / only sometimes in the midst of my play / a tune seems to hover over my playthings,'**
Complete: The poet is reminded of his mother during his ___.

✔ ANSWER

play (playtime)

I 1 (ii) **What is the primary emotion conveyed by 'a tune seems to hover over my playthings'? A. It enhances the joy of play. B. It disrupts the playtime atmosphere. C. It activates memories**

of the mother. D. It symbolises the carefree nature of childhood.

✔ ANSWER

C. It activates memories of the mother.

I 1 (iii) **What role does the hovering tune play during the speaker's playtime?**

✔ ANSWER

It brings back the faint memory of the song his mother hummed while rocking his cradle, so he feels her near him even while playing.

I 1 (iv) **True or false: The poet experiences the tune lingering over playthings only occasionally during playtime.**

✔ ANSWER

True – 'only sometimes in the midst of my play'.

I 1 (v) **How could the poet feel his mother's presence, even though she isn't there?**

✔ ANSWER

Through his senses – a tune he hears, the scent of shiuli flowers and the temple service, and the stillness of the sky remind him of her.

I 2 (i) **Extract: 'I feel that the stillness of / my mother's gaze on my face / has spread all over the sky.'**

What does the poet suggest? A. The mother's gaze is physically present in the sky. B. The sky is a symbolic extension of the mother's presence. C. The sky mirrors the mother's emotions. D. The stillness is fleeting and unrelated to the mother.

✔ ANSWER

B. The sky is a symbolic extension of the mother's presence.

I 2 (ii) **What emotion does the poet associate with the 'stillness' of his mother's gaze? A. grief B. anticipation C. nostalgia D. serenity**

✔ ANSWER

D. a sense of serenity – the stillness is calm and peaceful.

I 2 (iii) **True or false: The poet suggests that the mother's gaze has a tangible and visual effect on the sky.**

✔ ANSWER

False. It is only a feeling; the sky is a symbol of her loving gaze.

I 2 (iv) **What is the purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky?**

✔ ANSWER

To show that her love is vast, calm and everywhere, always watching over and protecting him, like the sky.

I 2 (v) **Complete: The tone of the poet in the given extract is ___ because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

tender and serene (nostalgic), because he feels comforted by his mother's loving gaze spread over the peaceful sky, though he cannot remember her.

II 1 **What is the emotional impact of the refrain, 'I cannot remember my mother'?**

✔ ANSWER

It repeats the poet's sorrow and longing, making the reader feel his loss. Each time, it is followed by a tender memory, so the poem moves from sadness to comfort.

II 2 **Interpret the connection between the poet's mother and (i) shiuli flowers (ii) humming tune.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) **Shiuli flowers:** their fragrance on autumn mornings, mixed with the scent of the temple service, smells to him like his mother – pure and gentle.

(ii) **Humming tune:** it is the song she hummed while rocking his cradle; it still seems to hover over his playthings.

II 3 **What role does nature play in the poet's description of the memory of his mother?**

✔ ANSWER

Nature carries his mother's memory: the autumn morning, the scent of shiuli flowers and the blue sky all remind him of her. Through nature he feels her presence all around him.

II 4 **What can be inferred about the poet's perception of the mother–child relationship?**

✔ ANSWER

He sees it as a deep, lasting bond. Even though he cannot remember her face, her love stays with him through sounds, smells and sights. A mother's love lives on beyond memory.

⭐ I Cannot Remember My Mother · Vocabulary in Context

I **Classify the sensory words into Visual, Auditory, Olfactory and Tactile:**

rustle, sticky, glowing, hiss, rough, chilled, aroma, gigantic, stale, sizzle, minuscule, scent, gloomy, deafening, vibrant, pungent, squeaky, stinky, crimson, fluffy, fragrant, smooth, slimy, ear-splitting, hairy

✔ ANSWER

Visual: glowing, gigantic, minuscule, gloomy, vibrant, crimson

Auditory: hiss, rustle, sizzle, deafening, squeaky, ear-splitting

Olfactory: aroma, stale, scent, pungent, stinky, fragrant

Tactile: sticky, rough, chilled, smooth, slimy, fluffy, hairy

II **Fill in the blanks with sensory words (two are extra): scarlet, shrill, sizzle, perfumes, flaming, scents, sweetness, essence, smooth**

...these 1. ___ lilies that adorn the sunshine; the voluptuous 2. ___ of neem and champak and serisha that beat upon the languid air with their implacable 3. ___; the thousand little ... birds bursting with the 4. ___ ecstasy of life in nesting time ... these heavy 5. ___ are my emotions dissolved into aerial 6. ___, this 7. ___ blue and gold sky is the 'very me'...

✔ ANSWER

1. **scarlet** 2. **scents** 3. **sweetness** 4. **shrill** 5. **perfumes** 6. **essence** 7. **flaming**

Extra words: sizzle, smooth.

(2 and 5 – 'scents'/'perfumes' – can be interchanged.)

III **Write numbers against each picture with the phrases that describe them:**

1. beats of music echo in air 2. melody of soothing scent, dancing in the air 3. fragrant breeze of blooming buds 4. gentle lullaby, a soft melody 5. colourful sky, painting a lively sight 6. attractive canvas painting the horizon

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Tabla (drums) – **1** (done as example)
- Incense sticks with rising smoke – **2**
- Hands holding white flowers – **3**
- Mother rocking a cradle – **4**
- Kites in the sky – **5**
- Sunset over water – **6**

(check the picture in your book)

I Cannot Remember My Mother · Listen and Respond

I **Match each statement 1–6 to speaker (i)–(iv). Two statements are not needed.**

1. The precious memories by the seaside are not the same anymore.

2. My grandfather's encouragement influences me in moments of difficulty.

3. The school days are a source of recollection to stay in touch.

4. Childhood days are about freedom and ordinary pleasures in outdoor activities.

5. Memories of school days are grandparents and my funny tales.

6. Parents urge us to be adventurous and discover nature but with limitations.

✔ ANSWER

Speaker (i) – **2**

Speaker (ii) – **4**

Speaker (iii) – **5**

Speaker (iv) – **1**

Not needed: 3 and 6

I Cannot Remember My Mother · Speaking Activity

I **Work in pairs. Speak about an object, song or place that is memorable for you (introduce it, describe it with sensory details, narrate the memory, its impact, why it is still meaningful).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

One of my favourite childhood memories is of my grandmother's small wooden box. It was dark brown, smooth to touch, and smelt of cardamom and old paper.

I have a clear memory of sitting beside her as she opened it and took out sweets and old photographs, telling me a story about each one.

It taught me to value family and little things. Even now, when I smell cardamom, I remember her warm voice. That is why this memory is still meaningful to me.

I Cannot Remember My Mother · Writing Task

I **Imagine you had been on a school trip to a scenic place which appealed to all your senses. Write a diary entry describing the place and why it was memorable (day, date, time; first person; sensory details; emotions; conclude with reflection).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Saturday, 14 December 2026, 9:30 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Today our school took us to a hill station near Dehradun, and it was the best trip of my life!

As soon as we got off the bus, the chilled mountain air touched my cheeks. Tall green pine trees stood all around and the sky was a bright, clear blue. I could smell fresh pine needles and wet earth. Birds chirped and a little stream gurgled over smooth, round stones. I dipped my hands in it – the water was icy cold!

At lunch we ate hot, spicy pakoras and sipped sweet ginger tea. In the evening the sun set behind the hills, painting the sky orange and pink. I felt so peaceful and happy that I did not want to leave.

This trip taught me how beautiful nature is and why we must protect it. I will never forget today.

Riya

📘 I Cannot Remember My Mother · Learning Beyond the Text

I **Gather more information on unique flowers of India – where they are found, how they look, what smell they emit, and their historical significance (e.g. Neelakurinji). Add more flowers to the list.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Neelakurinji: found in the Western Ghats (Munnar, Nilgiris); covers the hills in blue-purple flowers; blooms once in twelve years; the Nilgiri hills are said to take their name ('blue mountains') from it.

Lotus: found in ponds and lakes across India; pink or white with large petals; mild sweet smell; India's national flower and a symbol of purity.

Brahma Kamal: found high in the Himalayas (Uttarakhand); large white star-shaped flower; strong fragrance; blooms at night; the state flower of Uttarakhand, offered in temples.

Champak (Champa): found in many parts of India; yellow or cream flowers; very strong sweet fragrance; used in worship and to make perfumes.

II **Collect poems and songs on family, friends and their reminiscences in English and your own language, share them, and read 'I Remember, I Remember' by Thomas Hood.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- English: 'I Remember, I Remember' (Thomas Hood) – the poet recalls the house where he was born, the sunlit window and the flowers of his childhood.
- Hindi: 'Yeh kadamb ka ped' (Subhadra Kumari Chauhan) – a child's playful wish to be near his mother.
- Song: 'Tujhe sab hai pata, meri Maa' – about a mother's love.

Like Tagore, Hood looks back at childhood with longing; both poems show how small things – a tune, a flower, a window – keep memories alive.

🎉 Chapter 4 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.